

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Paige Turner

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Paige Turner

Investigative Arts Journalist

Paige asks innocent questions with a recorder visibly running. Her journalistic integrity is unmatched. Paige covers the art world for the Times of Tulsa the way other reporters cover city hall: money, power, access, and who benefits when everyone agrees to keep silent.

- Keeps asking **Barb Dwyer** for access to museum records. **Barb** keeps asking what the story is about.
- **Sue Venir** has threatened to quote Paige's own articles back to her in court.
- Calls **Reed DeLabel** to check dates and catalog references. **Reed** is delighted when a correction makes it into print.

ACTING TIPS

Curious, direct, quick, socially fearless. Ask questions people wish you would save for email.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Paige Turner. I am covering the gala. I just want to say in advance that absolutely nothing is off the record tonight.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Paige Turner

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

You were investigating Grant's collection and labor dealings. He threatened an injunction and demanded the name of your museum source as the price of withdrawing it. He confiscated your recorder after you refused.

Your other secret

You obtained internal documents through a source inside the Meridian. Protecting that source matters more to you than tonight's scoop.

Conversations to start

- Find out whether Grant found the full provenance spreadsheet or only excerpts.
- Keep your source's identity protected.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Paige Turner

The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *The house has its own cinema. Inspect the side the audience never sees.*
- 2 *A decorative vessel has traded its bouquet for evidence.*
- 3 *A green lamp cannot testify, but something near it can.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Paige Turner

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Paige Turner

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Grant threatened the report, my source and the paper's ability to publish. I had made a factual error he could use. I corrected that sentence and refused the name he wanted. The person who trusted me was not a term I could trade in a settlement.

IF MURDERER

Grant threatened the report, my source and the paper's ability to publish. I had made a factual error he could use. I corrected that sentence and refused the name he wanted. He intended to get that name whether the settlement was signed or not.



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Paige Turner

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Paige Turner

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I recovered my recorder from the side pocket of Grant's coat. He had taken it after I refused to name my source. I went into the cloakroom without permission and copied the recording before he could demand it deleted. The conversation included his offer to withdraw the injunction for a name. I had also corrected the sentence his lawyer challenged. Those are separate decisions. I intended to preserve evidence of both.

IF MURDERER

I recovered my recorder from the side pocket of Grant's coat. He had taken it after I refused to name my source. I went into the cloakroom without permission and copied the recording before he could demand it deleted. The conversation included his offer to withdraw the injunction for a name. I had also corrected the sentence his lawyer challenged. Those are separate decisions. I intended to preserve evidence of both.



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Paige Turner

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Paige Turner

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The recorder contains Grant's offer to withdraw the injunction for my source's name. My editor retained both the original report and the separate factual correction. My editor had received an earlier copy before Grant took the recorder. The recovered file matches that copy. I concealed the source and took back evidence without permission. The timestamps and the editor's copies corroborate those decisions. They do not require the source to trust Grant's promise.

IF MURDERER

That thick red line deletes the description that could identify my source. I handed Grant a working carbon. My editor retained the original. The deletion was deliberate, and I will defend it. Grant could challenge the reporting without buying the person who helped me do it. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my reporter's notebook. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass so he could mark the proof.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Paige Turner

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



Paige Turner

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I refused my source's name and took the recorder back without permission. My editor already held the recording and the factual correction. I did not kill Grant. I will publish the correction and retain his offer to withdraw the injunction for a name. Protecting the source does not excuse the sentence I got wrong; correcting it does not require surrendering them.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my reporter's notebook when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. He demanded my source's name. I called murder protecting a source. It was murder, and the correction I owed my readers still stands.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.
